



PTAB Meeting Minutes: April 15, 2026

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Peter Waldt, Mary Thill, Jimmy Cunningham, Richie Hewitt (Village Staff), three students from North Country Community College's Introduction to Wilderness Recreation Leadership Class (Public)

Meeting call to order by Chair at 6:01 p.m.

1. Approve March Meeting Minutes: Motion by Peter, Second by Mary

2. New Business:

- Introductions to new Village Parks and Ski Area Manager, Richie Hewitt. PTAB welcomed Richie, who started in March 2026. Richie introduced himself, from Saranac Lake, he and his wife raised five kids here, and he worked 14 years at Adirondack Airport wearing many hats. His predecessor John Dixon has taken a private sector job but is still advising on a volunteer basis. Three employees report to Richie. His goal for Pisgah and other parks is for them to be safe, fun places where people make memories. Preventative maintenance is a priority. Tubing has been out of commission and the demand is high but the pulley system is dysfunctional/inefficient, requiring four employees to operate.

3. Unfinished Business:

- Capital Improvement Plan: Mary reviewed it and we will ask Aurora to give us more information at the next meeting. PTAB looked briefly at the plan and agreed to check on it regularly to make sure our work aligns. The plan is flexible and will change as information about projects becomes available.
- Community Enhancement Fund: Jimmy reported that he and Stacy Allott are working with CEF, village staff, and Historic Saranac Lake on a project to install four clear "ghost" panels around downtown, tentatively one at the base of Ward Plumadore Park, two in Riverside Park, one at Berkeley Green.
- **Initiative and Park Updates:**
 - Annual Park Maintenance: PTAB will visit parks and note any issues or needs for DPW repairs or follow-up. Goal is to have all complete by mid-May before DPW busy maintenance season. Colleen to send out the Park Maintenance Checklist again to PTAB to assign themselves to parks, conduct reviews and add to checklist. Richie's goal is to inspect the parks every Monday to see if anything needs attention.
 - Ward-Plumadore Park: Colleen briefed Richie on PTAB's March recommendation to the village for a dining area at the top tier, i.e., tables and chairs so people can eat there. Discussion on ways to promote it; reach out to restaurants, Village and other social media. Explore need for power, WiFi, additional trash can.
 - Riverfront Park: Colleen briefed Richie on resident Brandon Devito's PTAB-endorsed proposal to rename Riverfront Park to Paddlers Park. PTAB waiting to hear back from Village on next steps. Richie concerned about platform/overlook structural integrity. Might be owned by NYSDOT. Richie will discuss with village code officer.

- Boothe River Park: Colleen will forward plans and make introductions between Richie and Scott McKim, chair of Boothe River Park. Focus still on raising \$1.5M.
- Mt. Pisgah: Richie will consult with village about restrooms at pickleball courts and will meet with subset of interested PTAB members at Pisgah for a general tour of the property.

4. Adjourn at 7:10 p.m. Motion by Peter, Second by Jimmy